SPECIAL FC

OFFICIAL CLUB CONSTITUTION

2026 EDITION

Abuja, Nigeria

"Respect the Game. Respect the Team."

PREAMBLE

We, the members of Special FC, established in Abuja, Nigeria, hereby adopt this Constitution to govern the conduct, operations, and administration of our club. This document exists to protect every member, ensure fairness on and off the pitch, and build a community where football is enjoyed with discipline, mutual respect, and brotherhood.

Every member, by virtue of joining Special FC, agrees to be bound by this Constitution in full. Ignorance of any rule herein shall not be accepted as a defence.

ARTICLE 1 — CLUB IDENTITY

1.1 The club shall be known as Special FC, based in Abuja, Federal Capital Territory, Nigeria.

1.2 Mission To foster friendship, physical fitness, and a love of football in a structured, respectful, and enjoyable environment.

1.3 Colours As designated by the club leadership and updated formally at the start of each season.

ARTICLE 2 — MEMBERSHIP

2.1 ELIGIBILITY

Membership is open to any individual invited or approved by the club leadership. No individual may participate in any club activity — training, match, or otherwise — without completing full registration.

2.2 REGISTRATION FEES

The comprehensive one-time registration fee for new members is:

Item	Amount
Match Bib	**₦2,500**
Club Registration	**₦1,500**
First Monthly Due	**₦1,000**
TOTAL	**₦5,000**

2.3 MONTHLY DUES

- Monthly dues are ₦1,000 per member, payable between the 1st and 5th of every month.
- Any payment made after the 5th of the month attracts an automatic fine of ₦500 — no exceptions, no negotiations.
- Failure to pay dues for two consecutive months without communication to the Treasurer may result in suspension from all club activities at the discretion of leadership.

2.4 MEMBERSHIP RIGHTS

A registered member in good financial standing shall have the right to:

- Participate in all club training sessions and matches
- Vote in annual leadership elections
- Be considered for official club roles
- Raise concerns and complaints through proper channels

2.5 UNREGISTERED PLAYERS

⚠ **Any unregistered individual who participates in any club activity is in breach of this Constitution.**

Unregistered players will be immediately and permanently banned from playing with Special FC.

Any club member who knowingly facilitates or fields an unregistered player is subject to disciplinary action by the leadership committee.

2.6 WHATSAPP GROUP CONDUCT

- The club's official WhatsApp group is the primary communication channel for all members.
- Every registered member is expected to remain in the group at all times.
- Any member who voluntarily exits the group — whether due to a grievance, a misunderstanding, or any personal reason — without prior communication and approval from leadership shall be liable to a returning fine of ₦10,000 before being re-added.
- Spamming the group with irrelevant, non-sports-related content is a fineable offence at the Manager's discretion. Keep the group on topic.
- Personal grievances must be settled through direct messages or in person — not in the group.

ARTICLE 3 — TRAINING SCHEDULE & ATTENDANCE

3.1 OFFICIAL TRAINING DAYS

Day	Time
Monday	4:00 PM – 6:30 PM
Wednesday	4:00 PM – 6:30 PM
Saturday	6:30 AM – 10:30 AM

3.2 MONDAY & WEDNESDAY SESSIONS

- There is no maximum number of sets and no strict late-coming cut-off during weekday sessions.
- Players may join any ongoing or new set provided enough players are available.
- A minimum of 3 unselected/waiting players must be available before a new set/team can be created.

3.3 SATURDAY SESSIONS — SET FORMATION RULES

Saturday is the primary session and operates under stricter structure:

- From 6:30 AM, sets may be formed freely as players arrive.
- Once the time reaches 8:00 AM, no additional team sets may be created. This is final.
- Any player arriving after 8:00 AM may not form or initiate a new set. They must wait for a tired or willing player to step off and replace them.
- A minimum of 3 unselected/waiting players is required before any new set is created, regardless of time before 8am.
- No lobbying, debating, or circumventing the 8:00 AM cut-off rule.

3.4 ATTENDANCE EXPECTATIONS

- Members are strongly encouraged to maintain consistent attendance at all scheduled training days.
- Extended unexplained absence of more than four (4) consecutive training days should be communicated to the Team Manager in advance.

ARTICLE 4 — MATCH & COMPETITION RULES

4.1 FORMAT

Special FC plays 6-a-side football: five (5) outfield players plus one (1) designated goalkeeper per team.

4.2 SCORING & POINTS

Result	Points
Win	3 Points
Draw	1 Point each
Loss	0 Points

4.3 TIEBREAKER ORDER

Where two or more teams finish level on points at the end of the season:

1. Goal Difference (GD)
2. Goals Scored (GF)
3. Head-to-Head result
4. Coin toss (last resort only)

4.4 PENALTY KICKS

- All penalties shall be taken from a distance of 6 feet from the goal line.
- The taking player may take a maximum of two (2) steps back before striking. No extended run-ups, no sprinting approaches.
- The goalkeeper must remain on the goal line with both feet until the ball is struck.
- Any violation of the run-up rule results in the kick being retaken.
- Any goalkeeper who steps off the line before the kick is struck — and the penalty is missed — will have the kick retaken.

4.5 GOALKEEPER RULES

The goalkeeper role is a position of responsibility, not optionality.

- Once a player is designated and agrees to play as goalkeeper for a team in any set, they are committed to that role for the full duration of that set or match.
- A goalkeeper may not abandon the post during active play to play outfield, leaving their team without a goalkeeper.

- Goalkeeper rotation is mandatory: after each completed set, the goalkeeper position must be rotated to a different player — unless the current goalkeeper explicitly volunteers to continue. In that case, they may do so.
- When a goalkeeper decides not to continue, they must personally nominate their replacement from within the team before the next set begins.
- Wilful abandonment of the goalkeeping post mid-set results in: (a) the player sitting out the following set entirely, and (b) a fine of ₦1,000 payable to the club.
- If a goalkeeper is genuinely injured, a replacement must be agreed upon by both teams before play resumes.

4.6 WALKOVERS

- A team that fails to field a minimum of 4 players (including goalkeeper) within 10 minutes of scheduled kick-off automatically concedes a 3 – 0 walkover.
- Repeated walkovers (2 or more in a season) may result in the team being reviewed for removal from the competition at the committee's discretion.

4.7 SUBSTITUTIONS

- Each team is allowed up to 3 substitutions per match.
- A player substituted in the first half may be brought back on in the second half — this counts as one of the 3 allowed substitutions.
- A player cannot be substituted twice within the same half.
- No substitutions are permitted for players dismissed with a red card.
- All substitutions must be communicated to the referee before taking effect.

ARTICLE 5 — CARDS & MATCH DISCIPLINE

5.1 YELLOW CARDS

- A yellow card is a formal caution recorded against the player.
- Two yellow cards in a single match equals an automatic red card and dismissal from the field.
- Three yellow cards accumulated across the season triggers a mandatory 1-match suspension.
- Every additional 2 yellow cards beyond the initial threshold triggers a further 1-match ban.
- Every yellow card issued attracts a fine of ₦500

Yellow card offences include: persistent fouling, dissent, time-wasting, unsporting behaviour, entering or leaving the field without permission.

5.2 RED CARDS

- A red card results in immediate dismissal for the remainder of that match.
- The dismissed player's team continues with one fewer player — no replacement is permitted.
- A red card carries a mandatory 1-match suspension at minimum and a fine of ₦1,000.
- Two red cards in a single season: 1-match suspension.

Red card offences include: serious foul play, violent conduct, deliberate handball to deny a goal, abusive language toward any player or official, spitting.

5.3 INSULTING THE REFEREE

- Verbally insulting, abusing, or disrespecting the designated referee — during or after a match — is a red card offence resulting in immediate dismissal.
- In addition to the red card and applicable match suspension, the offending player incurs a personal fine of ₦2,000.
- The referee's decision on all in-match matters is final and binding. Disagreements may be raised with the Team Manager after the session — not argued on the pitch.

ARTICLE 6 — PHYSICAL CONDUCT & VIOLENCE

⚠ **THIS SECTION IS NON-NEGOTIABLE.**

Special FC is a community built on brotherhood and football. Violence in any form — on or off the pitch — will not be tolerated.

No apology letter, regardless of its source, will substitute for the penalties outlined here.

6.1 PUSHING & SHOVING / FIGHTING — FULL PHYSICAL ALTERCATION / PHYSICAL AGGRESSION

Any player who pushes, shoves, or makes aggressive physical contact with any person outside of a normal football challenge, also any player who engages in a fight (throwing punches, wrestling, or sustained physical aggression) with any person connected to the club shall face:

- A 3 match day suspension, with a fine of ₦10,000, and 1-month suspension from all club activities + further punishment as determined by leadership.

Context	Player Fine	Additional Penalty
League Matches plus Training Days	**₦10,000**	1-month suspension from all club activities + further punishment as determined by leadership

- The fine must be paid in full within 7 days of the incident. Suspension remains in force until payment is made.
- A formal apology to the affected party, delivered/tendered in the group, is also required.
- A 3-matchday suspension from all league activity applies automatically.
- A leadership review may extend the ban further depending on severity.

6.2 NO SELF-HELP POLICY

- No member should take matters into their own hands. If there is a grievance — on or off the pitch — it must be raised with the Team Manager or Team Referee.
- 'He started it' is not a defence. Any member who retaliates physically is equally liable under this Constitution.

- Any member who encourages, instigates, or films a fight for entertainment rather than reporting it may also be subject to disciplinary review.

ARTICLE 7 — COMPLETE FINES TABLE

All fines are paid directly into the club account. The Treasurer records every offence, every fine issued, and every payment received. Monthly financial statements will include a fines log.

Offence	Fine	Additional Penalty
Monthly dues paid after 5th of month	**₦500**	—
Exiting the WhatsApp group	**₦10,000**	Returning fine before re-entry
Spamming non-sports content in group	**₦1,000**	At Manager's discretion
Insulting the Referee	**₦2,000**	Plus red card and suspension
Physical push/shove/Fighting	**₦10,000**	Plus suspension / Plus leadership-determined measures
Abandoning goalkeeper post mid-set	**₦1,000**	Plus sit out next full set

The club account should be cashing out — and it will. All funds go toward the betterment of the club: equipment, bibs, pitch fees, and season prizes.

ARTICLE 8 — LEADERSHIP STRUCTURE & RESPONSIBILITIES

Special FC shall be managed by a Leadership Committee consisting of four (4) officers. Each officer holds a defined role and clear accountability to the membership.

8.1 TEAM MANAGER

Role: Head of the club. Final decision-maker on all non-referee matters.

Responsibilities:

- Overall administration and direction of the club
- Final authority on all disciplinary matters, appeals, and complaints not resolved at lower levels
- Approving new member registrations and overseeing onboarding
- Calling and chairing all general and emergency meetings
- Representing Special FC in all external matters
- Ensuring this Constitution is upheld at all times by all members
- Appointing interim officers in the event of a mid-season vacancy

Accountability: Reports to the full membership. May be removed by a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote of active registered members at a duly convened general meeting.

8.2 PRO — PUBLIC RELATIONS OFFICER

Role: The official voice, communicator, and image custodian of Special FC.

Responsibilities:

- Managing all club communications across WhatsApp and any other official platform
- Announcing fixtures, match results, training schedules, and all club notices
- Documenting and archiving club history — photos, results, scorers, highlights
- Managing onboarding communications for newly registered members
- Moderating the WhatsApp group and maintaining a professional, positive tone
- Mediating minor interpersonal conflicts in the group before they escalate to leadership
- Pinning all official notices, results, and updates in the group

Accountability: Reports directly to the Team Manager. Responsible for the tone and professionalism of all public-facing communications from the club.

8.3 TREASURER

Role: The financial custodian and accountability officer of Special FC.

Responsibilities:

- Collecting and recording all registration fees, monthly dues, and fines
- Maintaining the official club account with full transparency

- Providing a monthly financial statement to the full membership by the 10th of each month
- Issuing acknowledgements or receipts for all payments received
- Flagging payment defaulters to the Team Manager for action
- Ensuring no funds are disbursed from the club account without the Manager's prior approval
- Safekeeping of all financial records and documentation

Accountability: Subject to financial audit by the Manager and any two (2) senior members at any time. Deliberate mismanagement, misappropriation, or concealment of club funds is an expellable offence.

8.4 TEAM REFEREE

Role: The law on the pitch. The Referee's authority during any active match is absolute.

Responsibilities:

- Officiating all club matches with full fairness and impartiality, regardless of personal relationships
- Enforcing all competition rules, including card issuance, penalty regulations, and substitution protocols
- Recording all cards, suspensions, and disciplinary incidents after every session and submitting a written report to the Team Manager
- Reporting all incidents of misconduct to the Team Manager immediately
- Maintaining composure and authority in all situations, including under pressure from players
- Refusing to be intimidated or influenced by any player or club member

Rights:

- The Referee has the right to abandon any match if player behaviour becomes unmanageable
- The Referee may issue cards for conduct that occurs in the immediate aftermath of the final whistle
- Any player who insults or threatens the Referee shall be referred directly to the full Leadership Committee

Accountability: Expected to be neutral, consistent, and professional at all times. Perceived bias may be raised as a formal complaint with the Team Manager after the session — this complaint must never be made on the pitch during an active match.

8.5 ELECTIONS

- All leadership positions shall be reviewed and re-elected annually on the 1st of December every year.
- Any registered member in good financial standing may contest a leadership position.
- Elections are by simple majority vote of all active registered members.
- If any position becomes vacant mid-season, the Manager shall appoint a competent interim officer until the next annual election.

ARTICLE 9 — MEETINGS & COMMUNICATION

9.1 GENERAL MEETINGS

- A general meeting of all members shall be held at least once per season — typically before the league season begins.
- Emergency meetings may be called by the Manager with at least 24 hours' notice.
- Quorum for any meeting to be valid is 50% plus one (1) of active registered members.

9.2 WHATSAPP GROUP PROTOCOL

- The official group is for club-related communication only.
- Personal arguments and grievances must be taken to private messages — not the group.
- The PRO moderates the group. Repeated disrespect or off-topic spam is a fineable offence (₦1,000) at the Manager's discretion.
- All key updates — results, fixtures, financial notices — shall be pinned by the PRO.

ARTICLE 10 — GRIEVANCES & APPEALS

10.1 RAISING A COMPLAINT

Any member with a complaint — about a result, a fine, a fellow member, or a leadership decision — must:

5. Raise it calmly and directly with the Team Manager or PRO
6. Allow 48 hours for the matter to be reviewed before escalating
7. Present their case factually in writing (WhatsApp message is acceptable)

10.2 APPEALS

- A disciplinary decision (suspension or fine) may be appealed to the full Leadership Committee within 48 hours of the decision being communicated.
- The Committee's collective decision on appeal is final and binding.

10.3 WHAT IS NOT APPEALABLE

- Referee decisions made during a live match
- Fines for offences explicitly defined in this Constitution
- Suspensions imposed for physical violence

ARTICLE 11 — AMENDMENTS

- This Constitution may be amended at any General Meeting by a two-thirds (2/3) majority of active members present.
- Proposed amendments must be shared with all members at least 72 hours before the meeting at which they will be voted upon.
- No amendment may be made during an active disciplinary proceeding that would retroactively affect the outcome of that proceeding.

ARTICLE 12 — ADOPTION

This Constitution comes into force from the date of its publication to the membership.

By participating in any Special FC training session, match, or club activity — whether in-person or via the official WhatsApp group — you are deemed to have read, understood, and agreed to every provision of this Constitution.

No physical signature is required. Participation is consent.

"We are not a court. We are not the government. But within Special FC, this Constitution is the law — and the law will be respected."

SPECIAL FC · Abuja, Nigeria · Constitution Adopted: 2026 · Custodian: Team Manager

Play hard. Play fair. Represent. ⚽